tion. Jainism works out a very imposing psychological superstructure of the spiritual destiny of man from start to finish. The Jains believe in five bodies or sheaths of the soul instead of the three or four bodies of the other systems. As the *Karmas* are destroyed bit by bit, the body acquires new qualities shedding its grosser manifestations; and as the bodies perish one after the other in the soul's ultimate march towards perfection, it passes through fourteen well-marked spiritual stages, the *Guṇasthānas.*

In summary, there are the two ultimate categories of *Jīva* and *Ajīva,* the six substances (one *Jīva* and five *Ajīvas),* the five stages of *Karma* with the two ultimate categories *(Tattvas,* or principles); and finally, if merit and demerit *(Pāpa* and *Puṇya)* are added to these seven principles, we have the nine *Padārthas* of Jainism. These are the fundamental principles of Jain metaphysics. Some critics of Jain metaphysics have found fault with this kind of cross division implying that the Jains had no clear concept of how many substances they really believed in. But such a criticism is founded on a lack of understanding, although Jain metaphysics is not very clear about the process of the creation of this actual world from these eternal categories and substances. This may be regarded as a weak thread in its metaphysics.

JAIN ETHICS

Jain ethics is a direct consequence of the Jain philosophy of soul and *Karma.* Since the primary duty of man is the evolution and perfection of his soul as well as of his fellow creatures, the principle of *Ahimsā,* or "non-hurting" of life irrespective of its distinction into higher and lower, is the cardinal principle of Jain ethics. Even the principle of truth may be sacrificed for the principle of *Ahimsā.* "Hurt no one" is a positive injunction enjoining love and compassion toward all fellow creatures. Jains alone build asylums and resthouses where old and diseased animals are kept and fed until they die a natural death. With a view to attainment of its cherished goal of *Mokṣa* by humanity as a whole, Jainism prescribes perhaps the most elaborate rules for practical everyday conduct. *Samyag Chāritra,* or right conduct, must follow *Samyag Darshan,* or right faith, and *Samyag Jyāna,* or right knowledge, and these three form the "three jewels," or the *triratna,* of Jainism.

Jain ethics is the most glorious part of Jainism. In one respect, it is quite simple, as the primary duty of man is the strict observance of the principle of *Ahimsā.* But, in another respect, it is